CRIMINALIZING REPORTING

Turkey v. Cansu Piskin

9 October 2026

CASE FOLLOW-UP REPORT

Procedural developments and verified outcomes

Independent research based on user-supplied TrialWatch materials

ABOUT THIS UPDATE

This independent research update follows the user-supplied TrialWatch material. It is not issued by the Clooney Foundation for Justice, TrialWatch, or the original authors. The earlier report supplies the historical baseline; later developments are supported by the sources cited here.

Jurisdiction	Turkey
Original report	July 2019
Dated update covered	7 May 2019
Research cutoff	9 October 2026
Historical assessment	TrialWatch grade D (original report only)

SCOPE AND METHOD

Research considered public court records, enacted legislation, lawyers and subjects, press-freedom organizations, United Nations materials and attributable reporting available through 9 October 2026. Publication dates and event dates are distinguished. Where judgments or current custody records could not be obtained, the conclusion is expressly qualified. No direct interviews or new trial monitoring were conducted for this update.

An acquittal, quashing order, pardon, sentence completion, bail decision and custody transfer have different legal effects. A reported intention to litigate is separated from an actual filing. Unresolved questions are listed below. Historical TrialWatch grades retain their original attribution; this update does not assign a new grade.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

LATEST VERIFIED POSITION

Ten-month sentence with five-year deferred pronouncement; closure unverified

This date is the last verified event in Piskin's own prosecution, not the latest appearance of her name online. Later reporting identifies her as an observer or author in other journalists' cases. No objection decision, activation of sentence, dismissal after supervision, acquittal, or international ruling in her own case was verified through 9 October 2026.

Cansu Piskin was found guilty on 7 May 2019 and given a ten-month prison sentence whose pronouncement was deferred for five years. That remains the last verified event in this specific prosecution. Contemporaneous MLSA, bianet and CPJ reporting corroborates the original's account; none establishes the eventual result of the deferred-judgment process. [1] [2] [3] [4]

Later public records must be read with particular care. A July 2024 report names Piskin as an observer of two other journalists' trial, while a January 2026 article bears her byline in coverage of another defendant. Neither is a later acquittal or appeal judgment for Piskin. The passage of five calendar years alone is not proof of legal closure. [5] [6]

1. User-supplied original report, July 2019.
2. Media and Law Studies Association, 7 May 2019. Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 month...
3. bianet, 8 May 2019. Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 month...
4. Committee to Protect Journalists, 9 May 2019. Turkey Crackdown Chronicle: Week of May 5, 2019
5. bianet, 3 July 2024. Former bianet journalists acquitted in insult...
6. P24 / Expression Interrupted, unknown (article describe.... Gazeteci Ismail Ari'nin yargilandigi dava eyl...

BACKGROUND AND PROCEDURAL HISTORY

The prosecution arose from Piskin's 5 April 2018 report about the investigation of Bogazici University students, identifying prosecutor Ercan Guclu. Istanbul's 36th High Criminal Court applied Article 6(1) of Anti-Terror Law No. 3713, concerning identification or targeting of officials engaged in counterterrorism. The defense argued that the name was already public and that the required intent had not been established. The original also questioned reopening a previously declined prosecution without new evidence. [1]

Ambassador Stephen J. Rapp awarded the proceedings a D grade. The original criticized the failure to address material defense arguments and the interference with freedom of expression. It recorded deferred pronouncement, commonly called HAGB, with a five-year supervisory period, rather than immediate service of ten months in prison. It also explained the restrictions on ordinary appeal associated with accepting deferment under the law applicable to this proceeding. That historical description should not be silently replaced by assumptions about later procedural reforms. [1]

KEY PROCEDURAL DATES

5 April 2018	Article identifying the prosecutor was published. [1]
7 May 2019	Guilty finding and ten-month sentence with pronouncement deferred for five years. [1] [2] [3] [4]
July 2019	Original TrialWatch report published with Ambassador Rapp's D assessment. [1]
3 July 2024	Publication identified Piskin as a P24 observer at proceedings against Haluk Kalafat and Elif Akgul; not her own case. [5]
13 January 2026	A report carrying Piskin's byline covered a hearing concerning Ismail Ari; the event date is that hearing's date, not a disposition of her prosecution. [6]

1. User-supplied original report, July 2019.
2. Media and Law Studies Association, 7 May 2019. Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 month...
3. bianet, 8 May 2019. Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 month...
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SUBSEQUENT DEVELOPMENTS

The contemporaneous accounts confirm deferment rather than an acquittal. MLSA's headline and substantive sentencing description, bianet, CPJ and the original agree on ten months. MLSA's introductory text contains an inconsistent reference to ten years; it is not adopted here. [1] [2] [3] [4]

The later sources document professional activity, not litigation progress in Piskin's case. Searches in English and Turkish for objections, constitutional proceedings, acquittal and dismissal did not yield an attributable later decision. That negative search result leaves the disposition unverified; it cannot establish that no decision exists. [5] [6]

LEGAL AND PROCEDURAL ASSESSMENT

The following assessment draws inferences from the cited record. It does not represent a new court finding or TrialWatch grade.

the key unresolved question is what happened to the deferred pronouncement, not whether ten months have passed. A supervision period may require examination of its start date, conditions, intervening decisions and an eventual order. Without the case docket, neither an operative prison sentence nor automatic dismissal can safely be asserted. [1]

the narrow record supports retaining the original discussion of criminalization and the chilling effects of a conditional disposition, while withholding a new evaluation of its ultimate legal consequences. Confusing Piskin's byline with defendant status would create a fictitious appellate history. The separate roles are explicit in the later sources. [1] [5] [6]

1. User-supplied original report, July 2019.
2. Media and Law Studies Association, 7 May 2019. Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 month...
3. bianet, 8 May 2019. Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 month...
4. Committee to Protect Journalists, 9 May 2019. Turkey Crackdown Chronicle: Week of May 5, 2019
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CONCLUSION AND OUTSTANDING RECORDS

The defensible update is limited: the 2019 deferred judgment is established, but its later disposition is not. Retain the original D grade with attribution. Do not label Piskin acquitted, currently imprisoned, or definitively cleared without a case-specific order. [1]

RECORDS NOT VERIFIED

1. Was an objection to the HAGB order filed, and was it accepted or rejected? Obtain the objection record rather than assuming an ordinary appeal.

2. When did the supervisory period legally begin, and was any order issued dismissing the prosecution or activating the sentence?

3. Did Piskin file an individual constitutional application or an ECHR application concerning this prosecution, and did either produce a decision? No actual filing or result was verified.

4. Can counsel or the court provide the later docket entries and final criminal-record consequences? Public reporting alone did not resolve these questions.

Failure to locate an update leaves a gap in the available evidence; it does not establish that no later proceeding or change occurred. Any present-status claim should be read with the dated scope stated in the executive summary.

1. User-supplied original report, July 2019.

SOURCES AND REFERENCES

Numbered references correspond to superscript citations and page notes. Web sources were consulted for this research through 9 October 2026. Original reports are local user-supplied files. Each link opens the cited source.

1. **Original user-supplied report on Turkey v. Cansu Piskin**
TrialWatch / original report authors. July 2019.
Local PDF: trial-monitoring-of-people-v-cansu-piskin.pdf
Coverage: Historical case baseline and original assessment

2. **Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 months in prison**
Media and Law Studies Association. 7 May 2019.
Read source at mlsaturkey.com
Coverage: Ten-month sentence and deferred pronouncement; Defense arguments; Opening reference to ten years is inconsistent with the headline and substantive account

3. **Journalist Cansu Piskin sentenced to 10 months in prison**
bianet. 8 May 2019.
Read source at bianet.org
Coverage: Verdict on 7 May 2019; Ten-month sentence with pronouncement deferred

4. **Turkey Crackdown Chronicle: Week of May 5, 2019**
Committee to Protect Journalists. 9 May 2019.
Read source at cpj.org
Coverage: Five-year conditional deferment; Other appeal outcomes on the same page concern other journalists

5. **Former bianet journalists acquitted in insulting Turkish nation case**
bianet. 3 July 2024.
Read source at bianet.org
Coverage: Piskin attended as an observer; Acquitted defendants were Haluk Kalafat and Elif Akgul, not Piskin

6. **Gazeteci Ismail Ari'nin yargilandigi dava eylul ayina ertelendi**
P24 / Expression Interrupted. unknown (article describes hearing on 2026-01-13).
Read source at www.expressioninterrupted.com
Coverage: Piskin is the author, not the defendant; The described January 2026 hearing concerns Ismail Ari